

KAIJA COLLETTE

Full Stack Developer | React | JavaScript | Node.js | Rust | SQL
240-620-4573 • kaijam7collette@email.com • kaijacollette.com (Portfolio)

Summary

Seasoned engineer with experience building scalable APIs, designing relational data systems, and evolving monolithic architectures into service-oriented systems. Proven ability to deliver high-performance backend solutions using Node.js and Rust, with a strong focus on system reliability, maintainability, and scalability. Experienced in owning backend features end-to-end and adapting across languages and technologies, with the ability to quickly ramp into new ecosystems.

Experience

LegalEase

Full Stack Developer / API & Infrastructure

2022 - Present

- Established a backend framework in Node.js, building REST API controllers, queries, and models to retrieve information from relational databases. Led projects to normalize redundant data across one-to-one and many-to-many relationships in MySQL (phpMyAdmin).
- Independently built multiple features and stories on a full stack platform for the company's Q2 major release, developing the web UI in React/JSX with functional components and reusable hooks, and turning Figma mockups into working interfaces that follow the team's design patterns.
- Built a Rust backend-for-frontend service between the React app and internal microservices, improving speed by 25%, reducing API calls, and strengthening network security.
- Leveraged AI-powered development tools to automate repetitive tasks, generate scripts, and improve test coverage, accelerating development cycles and focusing engineering effort on impactful user experiences.
- Managed codebase changes with Git, facilitating collaboration among team members and maintaining code integrity throughout the development lifecycle.

PCS Software

Software Engineer

2020 - 2021

- Implemented reusable backend logic and improved application performance through optimized data handling; debugged and resolved software defects to improve system reliability and maintainability.
- Quickly adapted to new languages and codebases, modifying existing software to add new features and developing and maintaining data pipelines with Node.js packages.
- Delivered backend features for production systems with a focus on reliability, performance, and long-term scalability, integrating RESTful APIs for dynamic content delivery and implementing reusable components for navigation and user interaction.
- Orchestrated Agile/Scrum project initiatives, ensuring efficient team collaboration and timely delivery of high-quality software. Facilitated regular stakeholder meetings to gather feedback, prioritize requirements, and align project goals with organizational objectives. Led bi-weekly Sprint Reviews and Backlog Refinements to track team progress and plan next steps.

Skills

React • TypeScript • SQL • REST API • Figma • JavaScript • HTML/CSS • AWS • phpMyAdmin • Jira • Bitbucket • Git • Cloud • UX/UI • LLM • Object Oriented Programming • Python • ClickUp • Rust • Node.js • Artificial Intelligence (AI) • Docker • Visual Studio Code • Databases • Unit Testing • MySQL • Continuous Integration/Continuous Deployment (CI/CD)

Education

University at Albany

Bachelor of Science - Informatics, Interactive User Experience Concentration

- Former Division 1 Student Athlete
- Minor - Emergency Preparedness, Homeland Security and Cybersecurity

University of Houston

Master of Science - Computer Science

- Summa Cum Laude